

VOCABULARY BUILDER

The World of Work Is Changing – Key Words and Phrases • Week 6 • Level A

The words and phrases below appear in the article *The World of Work Is Changing*. Study the table carefully, then complete the gap-fill exercise in Part 2.

PART 1 – VOCABULARY TABLE

WORD / PHRASE	DEFINITION	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
employment	the condition of having a paid job; being hired by a company or person	<i>Finding stable employment after university can take more time than many graduates expect.</i>
workplace	the physical or virtual location where someone does their job	<i>A positive workplace culture helps employees feel more motivated and valued.</i>
innovation	the process of creating new ideas, methods, or products to improve things	<i>Companies that encourage innovation tend to grow faster than those that do not.</i>
entrepreneur	a person who starts and runs their own business, often with a new idea	<i>She became an entrepreneur at 24, launching a successful app from her bedroom.</i>
remote work	working from a location other than the office, usually from home	<i>Remote work became much more common during and after the global pandemic.</i>
flexible hours	a work arrangement where employees can choose when they start and finish	<i>Flexible hours help workers manage personal responsibilities alongside their careers.</i>
salary	a fixed regular payment for a job, usually paid monthly	<i>She was offered a starting salary of £28,000 a year, plus an annual bonus.</i>
self-employed	working for yourself rather than for a company or employer	<i>Being self-employed means you manage your own time, clients, and income.</i>
career	a person's long-term professional life and progress in a particular field	<i>He built a successful career in marketing over more than twenty years.</i>
collaborate	to work together with other people to achieve a shared goal	<i>The design team collaborated closely with the engineers to develop the new product.</i>
deadline	a fixed date or time by which a task must be completed	<i>She always met her deadlines, even when the workload was very heavy.</i>
productivity	the rate at which useful work is completed; how efficiently tasks are done	<i>Working in a quiet environment can significantly improve your productivity.</i>
motivation	the desire and energy to do something; what drives a person to act	<i>Employees need more than a good salary — they also need motivation and purpose.</i>

WORD / PHRASE	DEFINITION	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
promotion	a move to a more senior or better-paid position within a company	<i>After three years of hard work, she finally received the promotion she had earned.</i>
resign	to formally leave a job by giving notice to your employer	<i>He decided to resign after his ideas were repeatedly ignored by management.</i>
redundant	no longer needed by an employer, often due to cost-cutting or restructuring	<i>When the factory closed, over 200 workers were made redundant.</i>
work-life balance	the healthy division of time and energy between work and personal life	<i>Good work-life balance is now one of the top priorities for job seekers worldwide.</i>
shift work	a work pattern where employees rotate between different hours, including nights	<i>Nurses and factory workers often do shift work, which can affect their sleep and social lives.</i>
apprenticeship	a training programme where someone learns a skill while earning a salary	<i>She chose an apprenticeship instead of university and qualified as an electrician in three years.</i>
pension	a regular payment received after retirement, built up during working life	<i>Many self-employed workers forget to save for a pension until it is too late.</i>
recruit	to find and hire new employees for a company or organisation	<i>The company plans to recruit fifty new staff members before the end of the year.</i>
commute	to travel regularly between home and the place of work	<i>He commutes two hours each day, which leaves him exhausted by the end of the week.</i>
freelance	working independently for different clients rather than for one employer	<i>She went freelance after ten years in an agency and now earns more than she ever did.</i>

PART 2 – GAP-FILL EXERCISE

Complete the sentences using the correct word or phrase from the word bank below. You may need to change the form of the word. Some sentences need more than one answer.

WORD BANK

employment	workplace	innovation	entrepreneur
remote work	flexible hours	salary	self-employed
career	collaborate	deadline	productivity
motivation	promotion	resign	redundant
work-life balance	shift work	apprenticeship	pension
recruit	commute	freelance	

1	Finding good _____ is important, but today's workers also care deeply about _____ — they do not want their job to take over their entire life.
2	She left the company to become _____, setting her own _____ hours and working from home rather than having to _____ every day.
3	The young _____ risked everything to launch his business — but his commitment to _____ paid off and the company grew quickly.
4	Her _____ as a graphic designer started with a _____ placement, where she earned a _____ while learning the profession.
5	Thanks to _____ work, she no longer has to _____ two hours a day, and her _____ has improved significantly.
6	He was offered a _____ after five years in the same role, which came with a higher _____ and a bigger team to manage.
7	The team needed to _____ closely to meet the _____ — everyone had a role to play and no one could afford to fall behind.
8	Many nurses do _____, which can disrupt sleep and make it hard to maintain a healthy _____.
9	When the company cut its budget, several long-serving employees were made _____ — a decision that badly damaged _____ across the whole team.
10	After feeling undervalued for months, she decided to _____ and look for a new role with better conditions.
11	The HR department has been asked to _____ twenty new engineers and to design a _____ programme for recent graduates.
12	As a _____ journalist, she works for several different newspapers and magazines, which keeps her work varied and interesting.
13	The company invests heavily in _____ by giving employees time to develop new ideas — and it shows in their results.
14	He is worried about his _____ — as a self-employed worker, he has to save money himself rather than relying on an employer's scheme.
15	A good _____ should feel inspiring rather than stressful — when people enjoy the environment, their _____ and _____ both improve.

Write your answers here:

1. _____	2. _____	3. _____
4. _____	5. _____	6. _____
7. _____	8. _____	9. _____

10. _____	11. _____	12. _____
13. _____	14. _____	15. _____